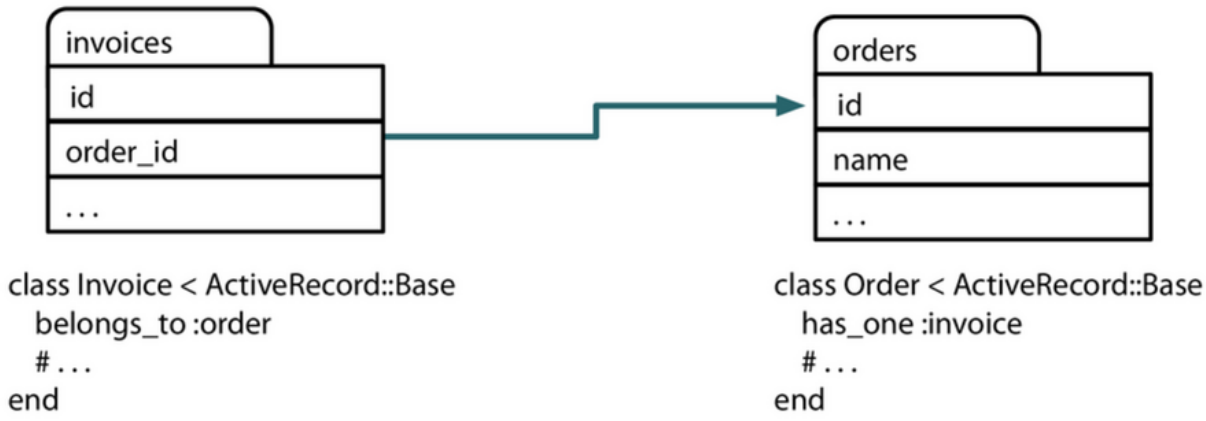
Specifying Relationships in Models

Active Record supports three types of relationship between tables: one-to-one, one-to-many, and many-to-many. You indicate these relationships by adding declarations to your models: `has_one`, `has_many`, `belongs_to`, and the wonderfully named `has_and_belongs_to_many`.

One-to-One Relationships

A one-to-one association (or, more accurately, a one-to-zero-or-one relationship) is implemented using a foreign key in one row in one table to reference at most a single row in another table. A *one-to-one* relationship might exist between orders and invoices: for each order there's at most one invoice.



As the example shows, we declare this in Rails by adding a `has_one` declaration to the `Order` model and by adding a `belongs_to` declaration to the `Invoice` model.

An important rule is illustrated here: the model for the table that contains the foreign key *always* has the `belongs_to` declaration.

One-to-Many Relationships

A one-to-many association allows you to represent a collection of objects. For example, an order might have any number of associated line items. In